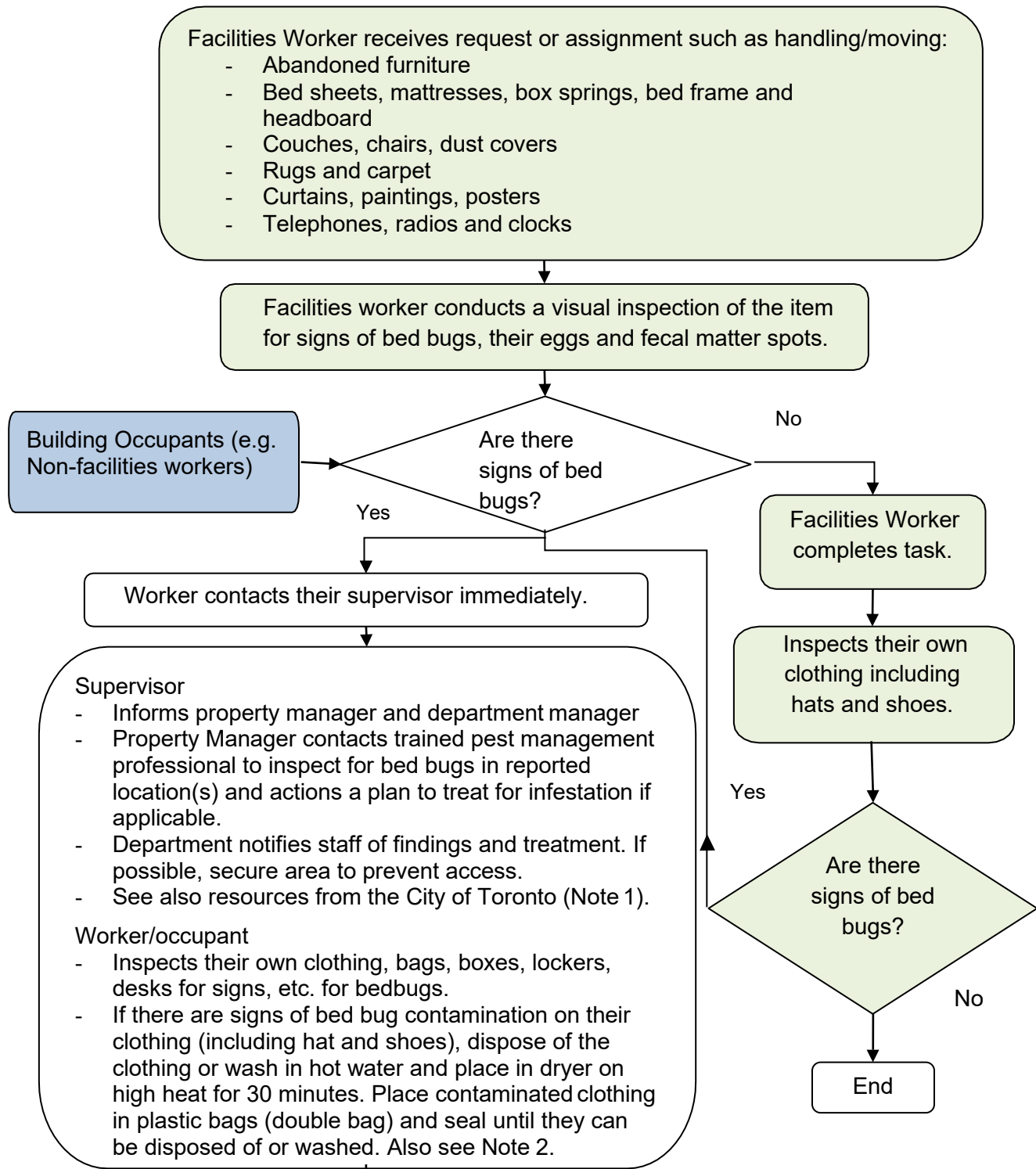
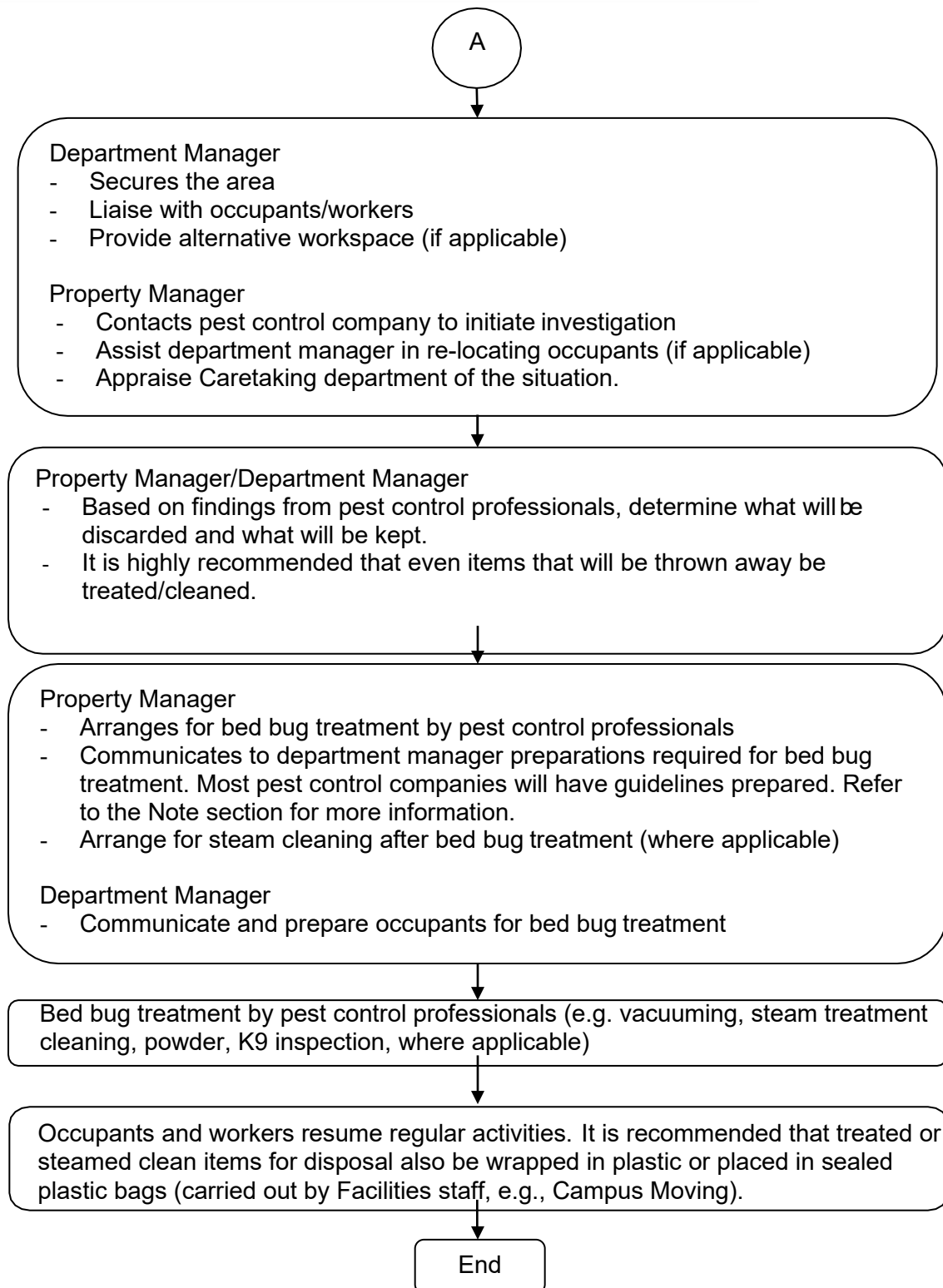




Bedbug Response flow chart



April 22, 2026



April 22, 2026



Notes:

1. Bed bugs and bed bug infestations are not considered a health hazard. However, secondary health concerns include skin infections and allergic reactions from insect bites, as well as the stress and anxiety of dealing with extreme infestations. Refer to the [City of Toronto website on bed bugs](#) for information of prevention, identification and treatment.
2. Bedbugs are hitchhikers and minor sightings do not mean there is an infestation. In addition to the flowchart above, occupants can also take some additional precautions to reduce the likelihood of hitchhiking:
 - Remove clutter.
 - Place items on hard surfaces (e.g. desk surface) vs soft surfaces (e.g. couch).
 - Inspect items before taking home or bring to work where applicable (e.g. coats, bags, shoes, etc.). Look for signs of bedbugs in nooks and crannies. Where possible, avoid clothing items that touch the floor.
 - If travelling via personal vehicle, consider using a covered plastic tub to place items in during transport.
 - Follow wash instructions below where applicable.
3. It is recommended that worker who are most likely to encounter bed bugs in their jobs maintain another set of clothing at the workplace.
4. The City of Toronto indicates that simple disposal of infested items is NOT a sound approach to bed bug control as re-infestation can occur easily and bed bugs may be spread in the processing of removing the furniture, etc. If the decision to throw out bed bug infested furniture/items is made, these are the City's recommendations:
 - Take apart, deface or damage the items so it cannot be re-used (i.e. make it unappealing for 3rd parties). Mattresses should be slashed or otherwise damaged to make it unusable and wrapped.
 - Wrap furniture in plastic so bed bugs cannot escape. This should be done in the unit before the mattress is removed.
 - Put in trash shortly before pick-up so it does not sit unattended for a long time.

If workers are to handle bed bug infested items, the following recommendations are made (by EHS):

- Wear disposable PPE: disposable hooded tyvek coveralls (head to toe), disposable shoes covers and disposable gloves are recommended. Double bag these items when

April 22, 2026



done for disposal.

- Wash clothes in hot water and then dry on high heat for at least 30 minutes. If it is not possible to wash the clothes immediately after, store clothing in sealed sturdy plastic bags (double bag) until they can be washed. If clothing is to be discarded, seal in plastic bag and follow instructions above for furniture.
- Shoes should be carefully inspected.
- Practice good hygiene (washing hands with soap and water before eating, drinking, smoking).

April 22, 2026